

DISPERSE BLUE DYE

Name

Date

also called... Disperse blue 106, Disperse blue 124, azo dyes, or plastosoluble textile dye.

What are they?

These dyes are the most common fabric coloring agents to cause allergy. They were developed to color synthetic fibers.

Where might it be found?

baseball cap bill
bedding
body suits
dark colored liners
dark polyester velour
dress clothing
fabric
headband
Lycra exercise clothing
lining for slacks, suits
nylon stockings
nylon underwear
pantyhose
plastics
polyester blouses
seatbelts
shoulder pads
socks
some diapers
Spandex sports gear
swimsuits
synthetic wigs
textile blends
uniforms (e.g. airline,
policeman, seaman)
velvet leggings

Around 20% of individuals who are allergic to disperse blue dye show cross-sensitivity to paraphenylenediamine, which is present in most hair dyes, some temporary hair coloring, black natural henna, and some temporary tattoos.

How to avoid it:

Avoid wearing clothing made from **these fabrics:**

Acetate	Spandex
Polyester	Polyester blends
Nylon	Polyethylene
Triacetate	Wool polyester blend

Allergic rash to textile dyes often shows up at sites where friction or perspiration causes contact with the dye. Commonly affected areas are inner thighs, backs of knees, buttocks, waist, genitalia, and tops of feet.

Since most colors are created by blending dyes, the causative clothing does not need to be blue.

Usually it is **safe** to **wear clothing made of:**

100% cotton
100% rayon
100% silk
100% linen
100% Tencel
100% wool
100% hemp
100% bamboo
Oeko-Tex fabrics
Levi Strauss 501 blue jeans

Fewer problems are likely with light colored and loose fitting garments. Remove offending dark linings and replace them with white liner.

Washing new clothing and bed linens 2 or 3 times before use may reduce the problem, although it does not eliminate all risk.

If an outer garment suspected of containing the dye must be worn, try wearing 100% silk or cotton long underwear underneath it.